

OS has gestures based controls which allows you to swipe right to translate the regional language to English and swipe left to transliterate – writing the regional text in the English script. Plus, the keyboard is also superior to Google's regional keyboard. For example, any time a letter is added in a regional language, two different suggestions pop up – a commonly used list of maatras and a list of predicted words. Indus OS has become the second most used operating system in India now!

06 AIR POLLUTION AND RELATED DISEASES

Fourteen out of fifteen of the most air-polluted cities in the world are in India! Cities like Agra, Delhi and more have people gasping for air. Large air purifiers are being installed in the cities along with tiny counterparts in homes and offices. Unsurprisingly, because necessity is the mother of innovation, there's a lot happening in Delhi. Kurin Systems is reportedly planning to install the world's largest air purifier in New Delhi, and another startup, Nanoclean, have created Nasofilters (fileters you wear in your nose) which can stop you from breathing harmful particles for a mere ₹10. The company claims that Nasofilters have a 95 per cent cleaning efficiency rate in blocking



Indus OS - a regional mobile operating system

PM2.5 – Particulate matter 2.5 causes respiratory and heart ailments. The team created nanofibres by bringing down the thread diameter of a normal fabric by 100 times which allows it to better filter out pollutants.

07 ROADS!

Lets be honest. Apart from a few roads across the country, the general condition of roads in India is pathetic. While most places have potholes, we have craters that would

make the moon jealous! we could blame it all on low-quality materials, corruption, a ridiculous amount of vehicles, etc., but the fact is we need a fix. The first step is identifying problems, and while municipal authorities cannot be everywhere at once, we the people are, and that's where the Spothole app comes in. Currently in Mumbai, Spothole allows citizens to report potholes to the municipality authorities. You click a picture of the hole and hit report. That's it. The app does the work of geotagging it, and sending it to the authorities. In true social style, the app shares the images with everyone else as well, so that people know where the potholes are, and if possible to avoid extremely potholed roads. There are also reports of 'smart roads and highways' being developed for Indian roads in the near future, which will enable roads to 'talk' or relay information about traffic and road conditions to vehicles.

08 WOMEN'S SAFETY

We need to do a lot more to keep India's women safe. Besides, it's not just women, but also men who are increasingly facing goons in everyday life. Although we haven't seen a one-stop revolutionary technology that is a solution, we do have many products and services that are trying to fix specific problems. Apps such as Raksha, Life 360, Shakti and more are using GPS services enabled in smartphones to track women and ensure they are safe when they travel alone. Additionally, wearables like Safelet, a safety bracelet for women, and Leaf, a company making jewellery wearables, also attempt to ensure women's safety in the country.

09 LACK OF SANITATION AND HYGIENE

Our vast population, especially in the big cities, makes sanitation and hygiene a huge problem. A lack of clean public toilets, clean drinking water and ineffective sewage systems seem to plague most cities in the country. Various startups are attempting to solve sanitation issues in India by installing public toilets. Ekam Eco Solutions, an Indian startup, has created a waterless urinal called Zerodor.

Because urine and water mix and give off ammonia, our urinals usually stink. By removing the water component, you take care of the odour issue, but also save on water that's pretty precious itself in many parts of India. Another app, called ToiletFirst, allows us to find and rate toilets around us. This is a boon when you need to go, but still want to make sure you go to a toilet that has been reported by others to be relatively clean and have running water... it also lists opening hours, type of toilet, parking facility, diaper changing room and cleanliness, etc.



Safelet is a safety bracelet for women which lets your family or friends track you when you are in danger.

10 WASTE MANAGEMENT

India generates more than 1,50,000 tonnes of municipal solid waste every single day, and Mumbai has been ranked the fifth most wasteful city in the world! Unfortunately, only 83 per cent of the waste is collected and only around 30 per cent is treated. Urbanisation and industrialisation have caused this massive growth of waste from India's metropolitan cities. Landfills, burning plastic and rubber and dumping of waste on the roads, rivers and seas are some of the most distressing issues here. Khalibottle is a Bengaluru-based startup that allows individuals or corporations to recycle and also get paid for doing so! However, you need to collect a minimum of 10 kgs of trash to avail this service. The trash is collected and segregated into predetermined categories, and then dispatched to recycling plants in cities like Mysuru, Bengaluru and Hyderabad. Raddi-Connect is another such organisation in the recycling sector.